

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

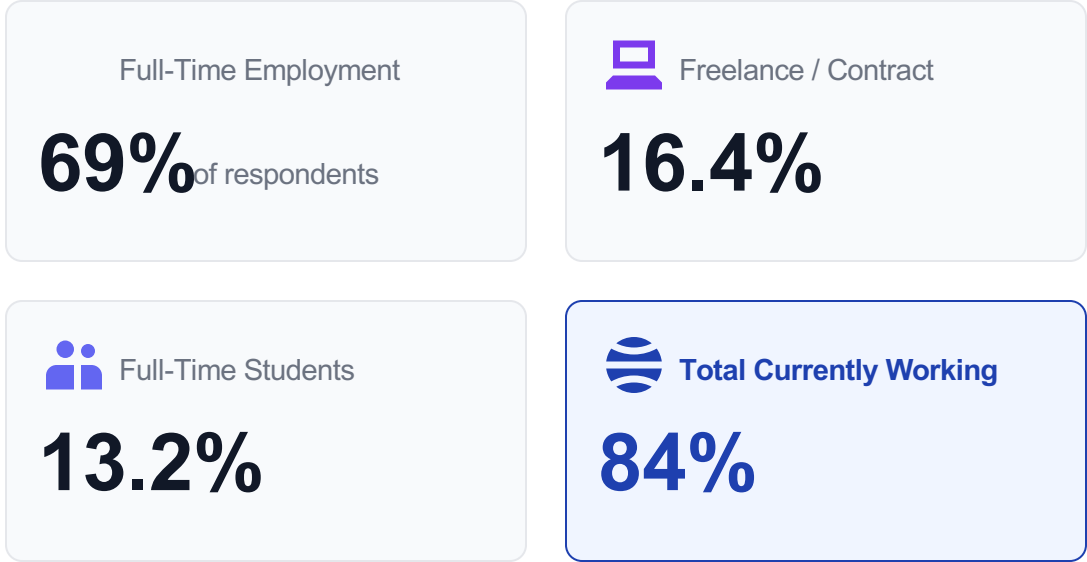
2024 Stack Overflow Developer Survey

65,437 RESPONDENTS · 180+ COUNTRIES

2024

84% of developers are employed, but U.S. full-time roles dropped 4pp year-over-year to 64.8%

Global Employment Status



U.S. Full-Time Employment Declining



▼ 4.2 percentage points YoY

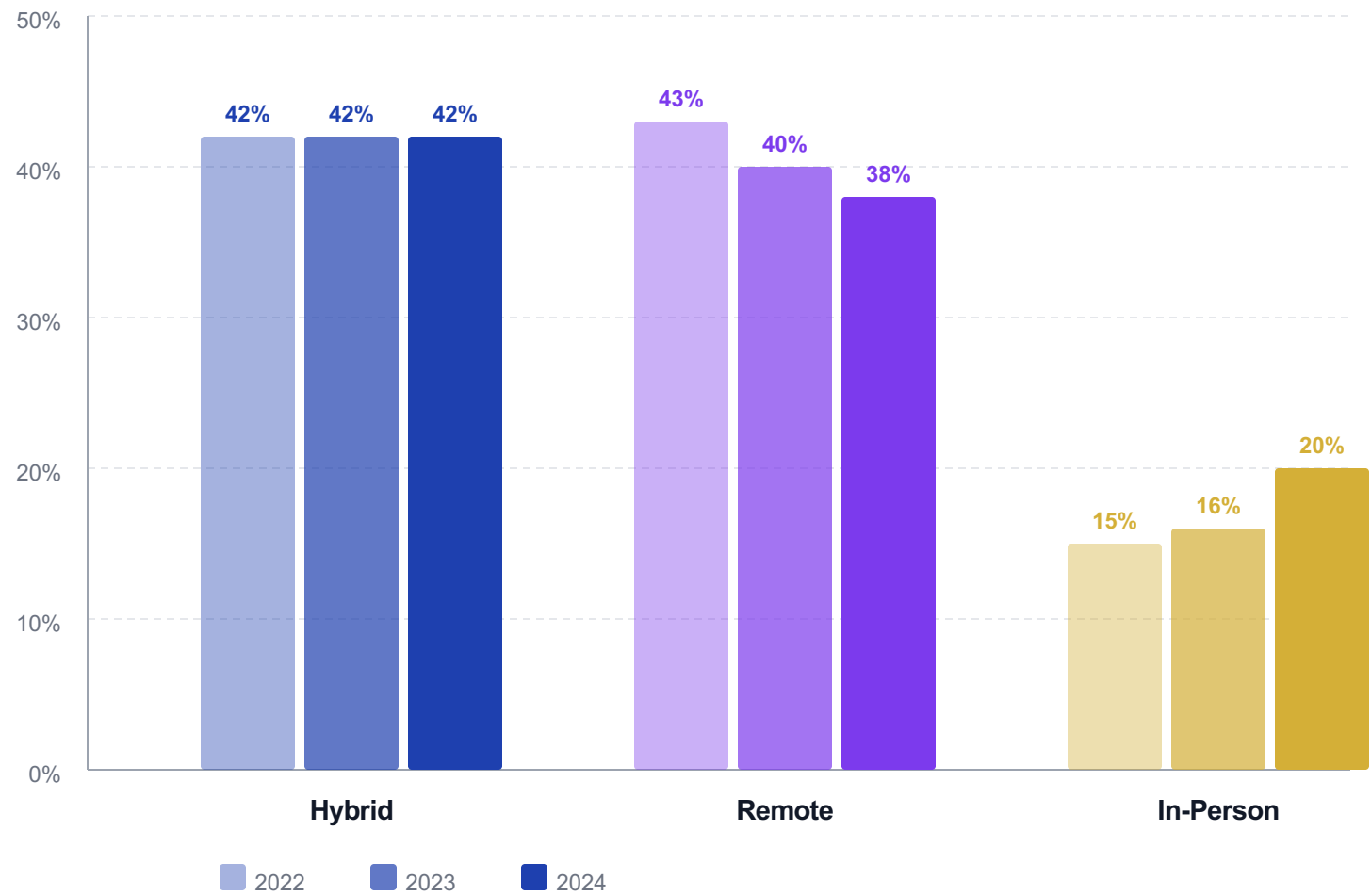
Regional Patterns

- UK & Ukraine: non-FT lean toward contracting
- Germany & India: non-FT lean toward students

N = 65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

In-person work rises to 20% for third consecutive year, while hybrid holds steady at 42%

Work Environment Distribution: 2022–2024



Key Insights

📈 In-Person Creeping Back

Rose from 15% to 20% in just two years — a 33% increase

💻 Hybrid Still Dominates

Stable at 42% for two years — the preferred arrangement

🌐 Remote Work Declining

Dropped from ~43% to 38% as offices reopen

Implication:

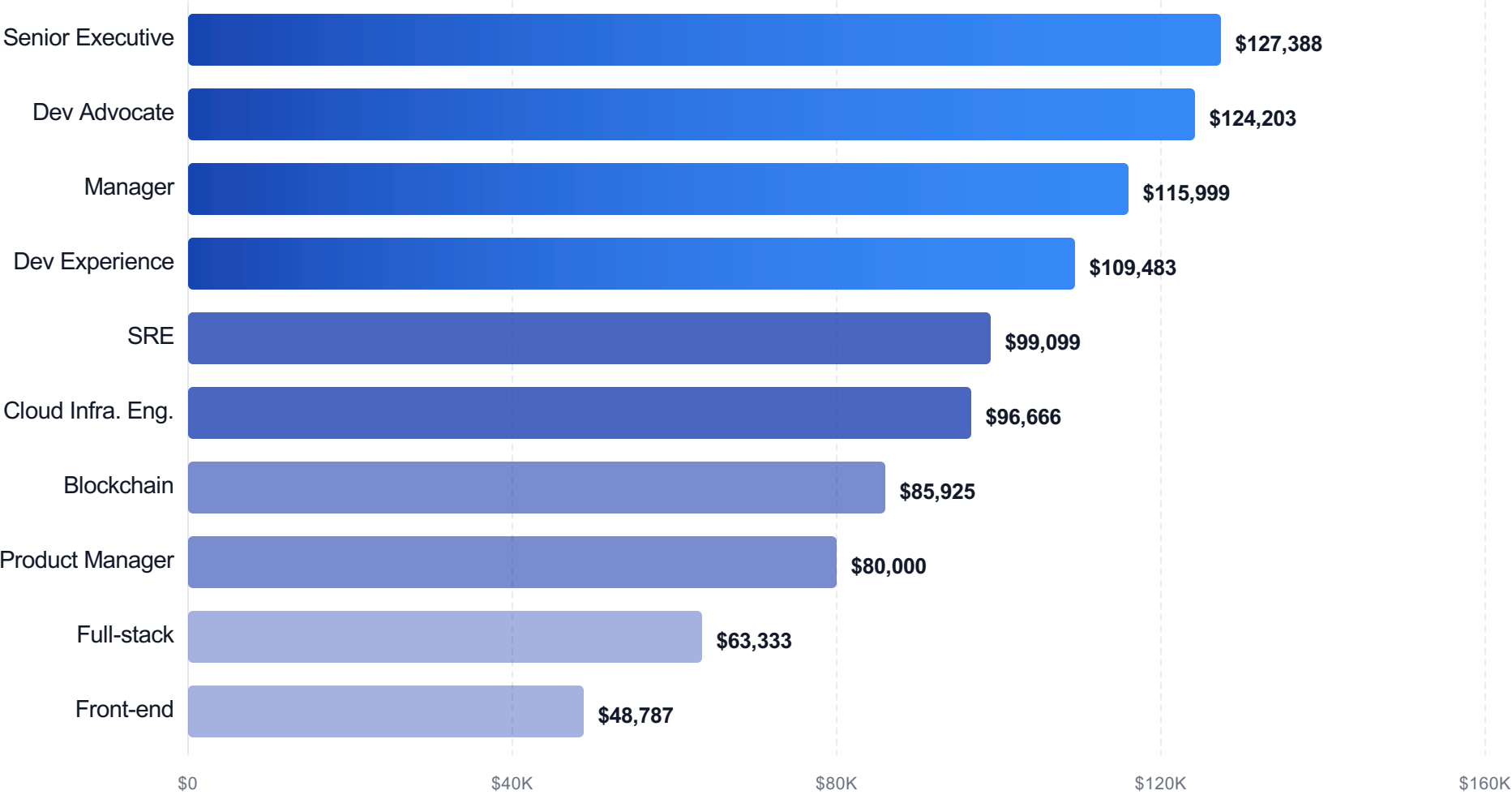
Office flexibility remains key for talent retention strategies

Senior Executives (\$127K) and Dev Advocates (\$124K) command the highest median salaries

Median Annual Salary by Developer Type (USD)

22,677 salary responses (34.7% response rate) · Top 10 roles shown

Ref: figure_1.jpg



Top roles combine 14+ years of experience with six-figure median salaries

Median Salary vs. Average Years of Experience by Developer Type

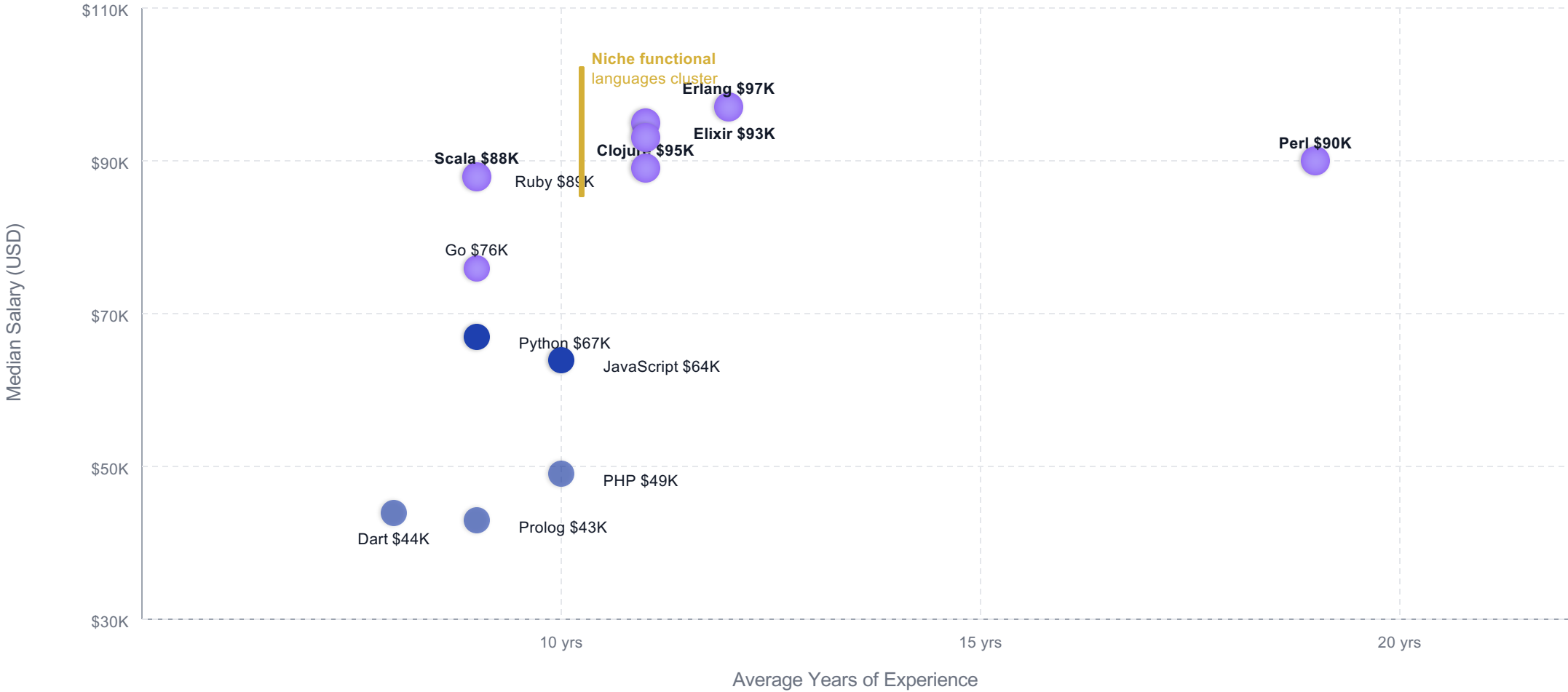
Ref: figure_2.jpg · Each dot represents a developer role



Niche functional languages (Erlang \$97K, Clojure \$95K) pay 40%+ more than mainstream (JS \$64K, PHP \$49K)

Median Salary vs. Experience by Programming Language

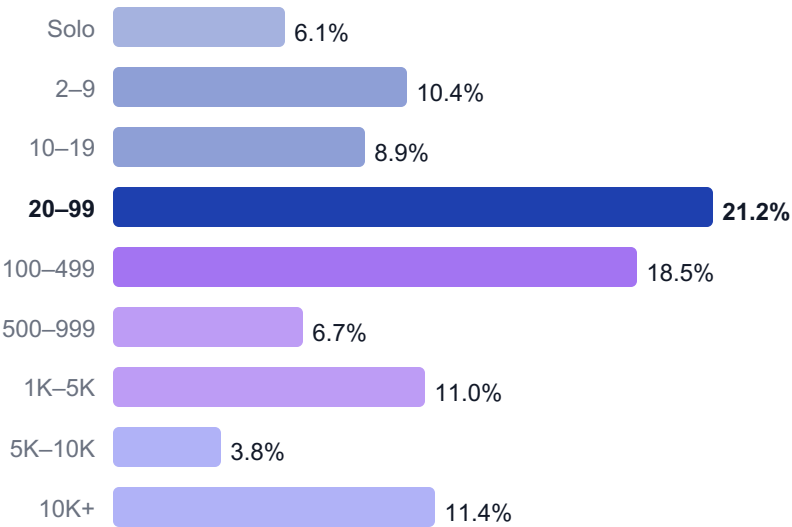
Ref: figure_3.jpg · Overall salary range dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023 (now \$60–75K avg vs. \$70–85K)



47% of developers work at sub-100 orgs; 62% influence technology purchasing decisions

Company Size Distribution

N=42,827 respondents



47% work at organizations with fewer than 100 employees

Technology Purchasing Influence

62%
of developers influence tech purchases

By Role:



How Developers Evaluate Tools

75%
Start a free trial

73%
Ask other developers

60% prefer a build-and-buy approach over purely building or buying

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

1. Full-Time Employment Is Softening

U.S. full-time dropped 4pp YoY; freelancing remains at 16%+. Plan for more contractors.

2. In-Person Mandates Growing

20% now in-office (up from 15% in 2022), but hybrid (42%) still dominates preferences.

3. DevRel & SRE Command Premium Pay

SRE (\$99K), Dev Advocates (\$124K), and Sr. Executives (\$127K) top the salary chart.

4. Niche Languages = Higher Pay

Erlang/Clojure/Elixir devs earn >\$93K; mainstream JS/PHP sit well below \$65K.

5. Developers Are Key Purchase Influencers — Engage ICs Directly

62% of developers have a say in tech buying decisions. 75% evaluate via free trials, 73% ask peers. Vendor strategies should target individual contributors, not just management.

Use these benchmarks to calibrate your 2025 compensation strategy